# Practical 6: Build the RetailPulse Customer Insights Dashboard

**Related topic:** Build a Dashboard for Customer Insights Visualization

## Objective

Assemble a dashboard combining a summary card, trend chart, segment breakdown, and a shared filter widget for RetailPulse customer data.

## Materials required

IBM Cognos Analytics access, RetailPulse Customers data module.

## Step-by-step procedure

1. Select **New > Dashboard**, choose a template/layout, then **Select a source** and pick the **RetailPulse Customers** data module.
2. Add a **Summary** visualization (KPI card) with a count of **Active Customers** (filtered to Active = Yes and the selected period).
3. Add a **Line chart**: X axis = Month, Y axis = Customer Count, colour/series = Customer Type (New vs Returning).
4. Add a **Bar chart**: X axis = Loyalty Segment, Y axis = Customer Count.
5. Add a **Selection control** (filter widget) on Region; in the Filters/Connections settings make sure it applies to all widgets (cross-filtering on).
6. Arrange widgets — filter at top, KPI card top-left, trend line wide in the middle, bar chart beside/below it — remove overlaps, then **Save** as "RetailPulse Customer Insights".

## Expected output (illustrative dashboard)

*Mock-up with sample numbers: KPI card, new-vs-returning trend line, loyalty-segment bar chart and a Region filter widget that cross-filters all three. (Segment bars sum to the KPI value, 48,215.)*

**Expected outcome**
All widgets show live customer data (no placeholders); selecting a region updates all widgets consistently; the trend line spans the full period; the layout has a clear hierarchy with no overlaps.